

Testing RESTful WebServices Made Easy



Introducing the WizTools.org RESTClient, a cross-platform tool to test RESTful WebServices and HTTP communications.

WizTools.org RESTClient is a Java application to test RESTful WebServices. It is also used for testing POX-WebServices (POX: Plain Old XML) over HTTP and other HTTP communications.

History

In early 2007, while working on a series of integration projects, we were using RESTful WebServices. To test our WebServices, I had started the project WizTools.org RESTClient (*rest-client*, googlecode.com). RESTful WebServices itself was born out of disillusionment with its more complex predecessor, the WS-* stack. The bigger technology companies, sitting in their ivory towers had designed the backbone of SOA (Service Oriented Architecture) using a series of specifications collectively called the WS-* stack. These include: SOAP, WSDL, UDDI, WS-Security and WS-Policy, among others (en.wikipedia.org/wiki/WS-). The hacker community, dissatisfied with the introduced complexity of WS-* stack, named a new architecture based on HTTP: RESTful WebServices. The word RESTful WebServices was coined by Roy Fielding in his PhD thesis, "*Architectural Styles and the Design of Network-based Software Architectures*" (www.ics.uci.edu/~fielding/pubs/dissertation/top.html).

RESTful WebServices did not aim at protocol independence. It leverages some lesser-known features

of the HTTP protocol. For example, using normal Web browsers, we can make HTTP GET and POST requests. In addition to the common GET and POST, RESTful WebServices use the following:

- PUT
- DELETE



Note: The HTTP specification also defines other request types like HEAD, OPTIONS and TRACE.

Back in 2007, we did not find decent clients to test these types of HTTP requests. Thus WizTools.org RESTClient was born.

Usage

RESTClient requires Java 6. To run the program, use the following command:

```
$ java -jar restclient-u-2.3-jar-with-dependencies.jar
```

Features

The initial idea behind RESTClient was to acquire the capability to make different kinds of HTTP requests, including GET, POST, PUT and DELETE. The latest version of RESTClient also supports other features like SSL, support for adding custom HTTP headers and